Lab 1 — Workspace Orientation

Description

A guided tour of the Azure Databricks workspace UI. You will open a workspace, work through the homepage, sidebar and menus, and locate where your own objects are stored. This lab is read-only — nothing is created or changed.

Learning Objectives

- Open an Azure Databricks workspace from the Azure portal or the account console.
- Navigate the homepage, sidebar, + New menu and search bar.
- Locate the three special workspace folders and your personal home folder.
- Identify which features your account is entitled to use.

Step by Step Guide

1. Open the workspace. In the Azure portal, open your Azure Databricks resource and click Launch Workspace. Alternatively, go to the account console, click Workspaces, and click Open on your workspace row. Note the workspace URL — it identifies the workspace and region.
2. Review the homepage. Identify the Ask Genie section at the top, which offers Ask, Search and Genie Code. Below it, note the Suggested, Favorited, Popular, Mosaic AI and What's new sections.
3. Explore the top of the sidebar. Locate the common categories: Workspace, Recents, Catalog, Jobs & Pipelines, Compute, Discover and Marketplace.
4. Explore the product areas in the sidebar. Scroll down and identify the three groupings — SQL (SQL Editor, Queries, Dashboards, Genie Agents, Alerts, Query History, SQL Warehouses), Data Engineering (Runs, Data Ingestion) and AI/ML (Playground, Agents, AI Gateway, Experiments, Features, Models, Serving).
5. Check your entitlements. A lock icon appears next to any sidebar item that requires an entitlement you have not been assigned. Note which items are locked for your account.
6. Browse the workspace file tree. Click Workspace in the sidebar. Identify the three special folders — Workspace, Shared and Users — which cannot be renamed or moved. Open Users and find your own home folder at /Workspace/Users/<your-username>
7. Inspect the + New menu. Click + New and review what can be created from here: workspace objects such as notebooks, queries and dashboards; compute resources such as clusters and SQL warehouses; and file uploads. Close the menu without creating anything.
8. Use the search bar. Use the search bar in the top bar to look for a workspace object by name. Note that recently viewed objects also appear here.

9. Open your user settings. Click your username in the top navigation bar and select Settings. On the Preferences tab, locate the workspace language option and, under Appearance, the Interface theme options.
10. Identify the workspace switcher. Click the workspace name in the top bar to see the list of workspaces your account can access.
11. Find in-product help. Click the Help icon in the top bar and review the options available, including Send Feedback and the Help Center.

Outcome

You can move confidently around the workspace UI, locate any object type from the sidebar or search bar, distinguish your personal home folder from shared and organisation-wide folders, and identify which platform features your account is currently entitled to use.